

WHISCO TV

POLICY SUITE

Eight working templates for a free AVOD / FAST service based in the Kingdom of Bahrain

Version 2.0 — 5 September 2026

Operator (current) Ali Albaharna, trading as Whisco TV · unincorporated

Intended entity Whisco Media W.L.L., trading as Whisco TV · under formation

Seat Kingdom of Bahrain

Service <https://whisco.tv> · official iOS and Android applications

Notices legal@whisco.tv

Classification Mix of public policies and internal procedures — see publication table

REQUIRES QUALIFIED LEGAL REVIEW

Every instrument in this suite is a working template. It is not legal advice, not a filed instrument, and not a substitute for review by a Bahrain-licensed lawyer (and, for US counterparties or a DMCA agent filing, US counsel). Do not publish, sign, or serve these texts until counsel has marked them up and the placeholders in Annex B are closed.

Documents in this suite

ID	Document	Public?
WT-CSV-001	Content Sourcing & Verification Policy	Summary public
WT-TDN-002	Rights-holder Takedown Policy & procedure	Yes
WT-ADS-003	Advertising Standards Policy	Condensed public
WT-PRV-004	Privacy Policy v2	Yes
WT-TOS-005	Terms of Service v2	Yes
WT-SEC-006	Data Protection & Security Policy	Internal only
WT-EDT-007	Editorial Independence & Curation Guidelines	Summary public
WT-PCC-008	Partner Code of Conduct	Shared with counterparties

How to use this suite

TEMPLATES ONLY

Counsel must confirm: (i) the correct contracting party once the commercial registration issues; (ii) PDPA notification / DPO questions under Law No. 30 of 2018 and Resolutions 43, 44 and 48 of 2022; (iii) whether catalogue aggregation triggers an IAA / media or TRA authorisation; (iv) the cross-border transfer basis for US processors (Vercel, Google, Apple); and (v) designated-representative publication under Article 52 of Law No. 22 of 2006.

Until incorporation completes, the natural-person operator is Ali Albaharna trading as Whisco TV. On issuance of the CR, replace the operator line in every public policy with Whisco Media W.L.L., trading as Whisco TV.

Review cycle: every 12 months, or within 30 days of incorporation, AdSense approval, first licensed-file ingest, or any app-store privacy-label change.

Facts this suite is written against (5 September 2026)

- Free, 100% ad-supported AVOD / FAST platform. No subscriptions. Ever.
- Catalogue: official-broadcaster / FTA / public-domain / contract-licensed only. Automated embeddability, duration and six-state GCC geo verification. Dead items hidden, not shown broken.
- Most current VOD is an official YouTube embed: the originating publisher earns in-player ads; Whisco earns page display ads. Own-player licensed files (Filmhub-class, rev-share, no MG) are the path to video pre-roll.
- Apps ship with store labels “Data Not Collected.” No analytics or ads SDKs in current binaries. Website uses Vercel cookieless Web Analytics. Optional accounts exist only to sync a watchlist.
- Advertising doctrine already in the product: maximum one slot per page, never adjacent to the player, no pop-unders or redirect networks.
- Takedowns already honoured at legal@whisco.tv. This suite formalises the SLA and the Article 52 representative.
- Executable by ≤2 people with heavy automation. No policy in this suite assumes a legal department, a DPO-in-residence, or a 24/7 SOC.

Contents

1. Content Sourcing & Verification Policy

Document ID WT-CSV-001

Classification Internal procedure + public summary

REQUIRES QUALIFIED LEGAL REVIEW

Formalises production practice. Does not create a representation that every automated gate is a legal opinion.

1.1 Purpose

Whisco TV exists to give Gulf expatriate households a legal, free way to watch television from home. The anti-piracy stance is the brand. This policy formalises the sourcing doctrine already running in production: official-broadcaster / free-to-air / public-domain / contract-licensed material only; automated embeddability and GCC geo verification before a title is shown; sanctions-list exclusions; prohibited-content categories; and a human override for edge cases.

1.2 Scope

Applies to every live channel, on-demand title, trailer, artwork, subtitle file, embed, deep link, and editorial guide published on whisco.tv or in official apps. Applies to automated discovery crons and to any future licensed ingest (Filmhub or successor).

1.3 Permitted sources (closed list)

A title or channel may enter the catalogue only if it falls in one of the following classes and survives the verification gates in §1.5.

1. Official broadcaster or studio distribution. The rights holder (or its authorised distributor) has published the work on an official channel, official website, official app, or official embeddable player, and the technical terms of that publication permit embedding or linking in the manner we use. Typical current pattern: official YouTube channel embed. In those plays the originating publisher, not Whisco, receives in-player advertising.
2. Free-to-air (FTA) transmission that is lawfully receivable in the relevant territory without a subscription, decryption key, or grey-market card. HLS or similar endpoints are used only where the operator has a good-faith basis that the stream is the official FTA feed and not a re-encoded pirate relay.
3. Public domain / expired term / official open licence (for example a Creative Commons licence that permits the contemplated use). Public-domain status is recorded with the jurisdiction and term rationale. “Available on the open web” is not public domain.
4. Contract licence. A written licence from the rights holder or an authorised marketplace covering the contemplated territory, language, term, and exploitation (AVOD / FAST, own-player, apps). Revenue-share only at the current stage; no minimum guarantees; no exclusivity sought.

Closed list. Anything that does not fit (1)–(4) is refused. “Everybody embeds this,” “the seller on Telegram has the m3u,” “the channel is popular in the labour camps,” and “we will take it down if someone complains” are not sources.

1.4 Expressly prohibited sources

- Pirate IPTV panels, sold m3u playlists, card-sharing, control-word dumps, ripped satellite relays, camrips, telesyncs, leaked screeners, and any feed whose operator will not identify itself as the rights holder.
- Geo-unblocking of pay-television or SVOD services (Shahid VIP, OSN+, beIN/TOD premium, Netflix, Prime, ZEE5 paid library, and equivalents).

- Demo, placeholder, or “coming soon” files that impersonate a licensed title.
- Content whose only availability is a third-party scrape of an official player that itself forbids embedding.
- Any source that requires the user to install a sideloaded APK, a VPN configuration we supply, or a modified DNS.

1.5 Verification gates

Automated gates run before first publication and on a recurring schedule. A failure hides the title; it is not shown in a broken state.

Gate	What it checks	Cadence
Source class	Item maps to §1.3 class 1–4; source URL / licensor ID stored	On ingest
Embeddability	Official player permits the embed; embedding not disabled	On ingest + rotating VOD batches
Duration / integrity	Real title, not a bait clip or malware interstitial	On ingest
GCC geo	Playable in BH, SA, AE, KW, QA, OM, or marked limited	On ingest + recurring
Health (live)	Two-hop HLS / live-endpoint validation	Every 6 hours
Sanctions / exclusion	Source entity not on the §1.6 list	On ingest + list refresh
Prohibited content	Does not fall in §1.7	On ingest + flag / notice

Titles that fail GCC geo are hidden, not shown broken (approximately 2,360 titles in that state as of 5 September 2026). Dead live channels are auto-hidden and auto-restored when the official endpoint recovers.

Human override: the founder may reject a title that passed the gates if the source looks commercially pirate, politically sanctioned, or brand-damaging. The founder may not override a failed gate to force a title live.

1.6 Sanctions and exclusion list

Whisco will not carry channels or VOD libraries operated by, or that are the official mouthpiece of, persons or entities designated on:

- the UN Security Council consolidated list;
- the US OFAC SDN list, where carrying the service would reasonably be viewed as a US-nexus dealing (AdSense, Vercel, Apple and Google accounts create a US processing nexus — treat this conservatively);
- the EU and UK consolidated lists;
- Bahrain, UAE, KSA and other GCC domestic terrorism / sanctions designations that are published and identifiable.

When a designation is added, matching catalogue items are hidden within one verification cycle (target: 24 hours). This is a compliance control, not a political editorial.

1.7 Prohibited-content categories

Regardless of source class, the following will not be published:

1. Child sexual abuse material, child sexual exploitation, or sexual content involving anyone who is or appears to be under 18. Zero tolerance. Report to the relevant hotline and law enforcement where required.
2. Pornography and explicit sexual content. The product is a family living-room service.

3. Content that instructs the commission of violent crime, terrorism, or the manufacture of weapons or explosives.
4. Content that incites hatred or violence against a protected group.
5. Content that is unlawful in the Kingdom of Bahrain or, for geo-targeted shelves, in the destination GCC state — including material that is obscene, that insults the Islamic religion, or that is otherwise restricted under applicable media law. Counsel must map this clause to the live text of Bahrain Press and Electronic Media Law No. 41 of 2025 and any TRA / IA guidance before the public summary is published.
6. Malware, phishing, or any title whose playback installs software on the user's device.
7. Gambling services, real-money betting tips packaged as programming, and advertisements for the same.
8. Counterfeit-goods storefronts and fraud schemes.
9. Anything whose inclusion would make a true anti-piracy statement false.

News, documentary, historical, and religious programming is not prohibited merely because it is politically contested. The test is lawfulness and source class, not the founder's taste.

1.8 YouTube and third-party player terms

- Use only the official embed / IFrame API in the manner YouTube's terms permit.
- Do not wrap, download, re-encode, or proxy the media file.
- Do not disable or overlay the originating player's advertising.
- Do not claim the originating publisher's views or ad revenue as Whisco's.
- If YouTube or the channel owner disables embedding, the title is hidden on the next verification pass.

The same principle applies to any future official player (broadcaster sites, licensed CDNs).

1.9 Licensed-file ingest (own player)

- Territory, language, term, and AVOD rights must be in the contract before the file is playable.
- Files land on the contracted CDN (planned: S3-compatible ingest via Bunny CDN or successor), not on a shared unofficial host.
- Artwork and subtitles travel with the same licence.
- Monthly reporting to the licensor is generated from playback logs, not invented.
- Rev-share only; no MG; no exclusivity at this stage, unless counsel and the founder later decide otherwise in a signed amendment.

1.10 Record-keeping and roles

For every live catalogue item the system stores, at minimum: source class, source URL or licence ID, timestamp of last embed / geo / health check, and hide reason if hidden. Catalogue snapshots are committed to git and restorable.

Founder: final reject / restore; sanctions-list decisions; partner contracts. Automated ops: discovery, gates, health, hide/restore, snapshot. legal@whisco.tv: takedowns and partner notices. No one is authorised to add a source that fails §1.3–§1.5.

2. Rights-holder Takedown Policy and Procedure

Document ID WT-TDN-002

Classification Public

REQUIRES QUALIFIED LEGAL REVIEW

Written against Law No. 22 of 2006 (as amended, including Law No. 5 of 2014), Articles 52, 55 and 56, and the Bahrain–United States FTA Chapter 14 side-letter model. It is also usable by US rights holders accustomed to 17 U.S.C. § 512. It is not a claim that Whisco is a US service provider, and it is not a filed DMCA designated-agent registration with the US Copyright Office.

2.1 Designated representative (Article 52)

Until a company officer is appointed in writing after incorporation:

- Name: Ali Albaharna, Founder
- Electronic mail: legal@whisco.tv
- Postal address: [insert registered address of Whisco Media W.L.L. on CR issuance; until then, founder's Bahrain mailing address to be inserted by counsel]
- Telephone: [insert]

These particulars will be published on a publicly accessible page at <https://whisco.tv/legal/takedown> and, if counsel so advises, in any ministerially designated public directory.

2.2 What we honour

We honour good-faith notices from rights holders and their authorised agents concerning copyright and neighbouring rights in films, series, broadcasts, musical works and artwork; trade-mark misuse in titles, artwork or channel brands; a demand that an official embed be removed because the originating publisher has withdrawn embedding permission; and a court order or Public Prosecution direction issued in the Kingdom of Bahrain.

We also remove, on our own initiative, anything that fails Policy 1. We do not wait for a notice to hide an obvious pirate feed.

2.3 Effective notice (Article 55 / FTA model)

To be treated as an effective notice, a communication to legal@whisco.tv should be in writing (email is accepted) and should substantially contain:

1. The identity, geographical address, email address and telephone number of the complaining party or its authorised agent.
2. Identification of the work claimed to be infringed (title, year, official identifier if known).
3. Information reasonably sufficient to locate the material on Whisco (URL of the title page, channel name, or app screen).
4. A statement that the complaining party has a good-faith belief that the use is not authorised by the rights holder, its agent, or the law.
5. A statement that the information in the notice is accurate, and that the complaining party is the rights holder or is authorised to act.
6. A signature. Email from a verifiable corporate or counsel domain is accepted as an electronic signature for operational purposes; counsel may require a stricter form for Article 55 formal effectiveness.

Incomplete notices are not ignored. We reply once, stating what is missing, and we may still hide the item if the claim is specific and plausible. Do not send the copyrighted file itself. Send the URL on whisco.tv.

2.4 Service-level targets

Step	Target (Bahrain time)
Acknowledge receipt	1 business day
Good-faith assessment	2 business days from a complete notice
Hide / disable if the notice is effective or the item fails Policy 1	Same window — target under 48 hours; sooner for an obvious pirate feed or CSAM
Written outcome to the complainant	3 business days
Notify the source / uploading partner if the item is licensed-file content	Same window
Restore	Only after an effective counter-notice and the waiting period in §2.6, or if we independently conclude the notice was mistaken

Business days exclude Friday and Saturday and Bahrain public holidays. CSAM and court orders are acted on the same day they are understood. This SLA is an operational commitment. It is not a waiver of any shorter statutory period. A two-person company will hide first and analyse second when the alternative is leaving a pirate title live.

2.5 What we do with the item

- The title or channel is hidden from web and apps (the same hide flag used by the verification system).
- We do not geo-fence a pirate title as a compromise. Hidden means hidden in all territories.
- We record the notice, the hide timestamp, and the outcome in the takedown log.
- Repeat notices about the same URL after a hide are acknowledged and closed against the log.

2.6 Counter-notice (Article 56)

A user or partner who believes material was hidden by mistake or misidentification may send a counter-notice to legal@whisco.tv containing: identity, address, email, telephone; identification of the material and its former location; a good-faith statement that the material was hidden by mistake or misidentification; consent to the jurisdiction of the competent courts of the Kingdom of Bahrain and an address for service in Bahrain (or an appointed agent); and a signature.

On an effective counter-notice we promptly forward it to the original complainant, and we restore the material not sooner than 10 days and not later than 14 days after we forward the counter-notice, unless the original complainant notifies us that they have filed a court action seeking to restrain the user or partner, or unless Policy 1 independently forbids restoration (pirate source, sanctions, prohibited category). Policy 1 always wins. A counter-notice cannot force a pirate feed back on.

Counsel must confirm the 10–14 day window against the live text of Articles 55–57 and any ministerial order before this paragraph is published.

2.7 Misrepresentation, orders, transparency

A person who knowingly materially misrepresents that material is infringing, or that material was hidden by mistake, may be liable under Bahrain law for resulting damages. We reserve the right to ignore notices from a sender with a documented pattern of bad-faith notices.

A direction of a competent Bahraini court, the Public Prosecution, or another authority with jurisdiction is implemented as written, on the timeline the order specifies, without waiting for the SLA above.

We do not publish a live transparency report while traffic is early-stage and the numbers would be noise. We will add an annual count of notices received / items hidden / items restored once the figure is meaningful. Individual notices are not published.

3. Advertising Standards Policy

Document ID WT-ADS-003

Classification Public (condensed) + internal full text

REQUIRES QUALIFIED LEGAL REVIEW

Product rules below are already operating doctrine. Creative restrictions must be mapped by counsel to live GCC advertising and child-digital-safety rules before a media kit is sold.

3.1 Doctrine

Whisco is free forever. Revenue comes from advertising, not from subscriptions. Advertising is not allowed to buy a worse product. Market research on regional free apps is unambiguous: ad overload is the number-one user complaint. Restraint is a designed differentiator, not a temporary courtesy.

3.2 Density and placement (non-negotiable)

1. Maximum one advertising slot per page or per app screen, except that a licensed-file title playing in Whisco's own player may carry a single pre-roll (and, later, a single mid-roll only if a written partner agreement requires it and the founder approves).
2. No advertisement adjacent to the player. Display ads sit in the page chrome — header, footer, or a clearly separated rail — never over the video, never in the first 24 CSS pixels around the player, never as a pause-overlay that impersonates a play button.
3. No pop-unders, pop-ups, tab-napping, forced redirects, push-notification subscription prompts, or download-interstitials. Ever. No “you must wait 5 seconds” gates.
4. No ads inside editorial guides that are written as user help. One slot on the page chrome is enough.
5. No second network stacked under AdSense (or its successor) to “fill unsold.” If the primary network returns no fill, the slot stays empty.

These rules bind the founder, the engineering agent, and any future monetisation partner. A higher fill rate is not a reason to break them.

3.3 Permitted and prohibited demand

Current: Google AdSense display inventory, subject to approval and to Google's publisher policies.

Planned: video ads against own-player licensed files; later, direct sponsorships for GCC brands sold against a media kit that uses only real analytics.

Prohibited demand sources: pop-under networks, push-ad networks, crypto-mining scripts, “rewarded” installs, survey walls, and any SDK that would force an app-store privacy-label change without a coordinated Policy 4 update.

3.4 Creative standards

Ads must not contain, promote, or link to: alcohol, tobacco, vape, narcotics; real-money gambling, betting, or lottery (fantasy-sports grey area: default no); pornography or dating hooks that are sexual in presentation; weapons or ammunition storefronts; political campaigning; content that insults religion, the State, or public morals under applicable GCC advertising norms; unlawful medical or weight-loss claims; pirate IPTV subscriptions, cracked APKs, or “free Netflix” lookalikes; anything that looks like a Whisco system notice.

Where AdSense is the sole demand source, blocking controls are configured to the strictest readily available category blocks that match this list. Direct-sold creatives are reviewed by the founder before flight.

3.5 Child-directed inventory

Whisco is a general-audience family living-room service. It is not directed at children.

- We do not create shelves, artwork, or marketing whose primary audience is children under 13 (COPPA benchmark) or under the higher age that applicable GCC child-digital-safety rules may set. Counsel to confirm the live age threshold in Bahrain and in each destination storefront.
- We do not collect personal data from children (see Policy 4).
- We do not run interest-based advertising against content that is primarily child-directed. If a licensed children's title is ever added under a contract, that title's page is treated as child-directed: contextual ads only, no remarketing, no profile building, and the ad slot may be suppressed entirely.
- Food advertising that would be child-directed is assessed against GSO 2725:2025 if and when such inventory exists.
- Apps currently ship with store labels "Data Not Collected." That label is incompatible with most advertising and measurement SDKs. No ad SDK ships in the apps until (a) a v1.1 store submission updates the labels, (b) Policy 4 is revised, and (c) the founder signs off.

3.6 Sponsorships and complaints

A paid sponsorship is labelled "Sponsored" (and the Arabic equivalent) on the surface where it appears. We do not sell unmarked featured placement. See Policy 7.

Ads that violate this policy: legal@whisco.tv. We hide the slot or block the creative. If a pop-under came from our page, it is our problem.

4. Privacy Policy v2

Document ID WT-PRV-004

Classification Public

Proposed effective date On publication after legal review

REQUIRES QUALIFIED LEGAL REVIEW

Drafted against Law No. 30 of 2018 (PDPL) and PDPA Resolutions No. 43, 44 and 48 of 2022, and — for EEA/UK visitors — the shape of GDPR rights. Counsel must confirm PDPA notification / prior-authorisation duties, whether a DPO must be appointed, and the legal basis for transfers to the United States.

4.1 Who we are

Data controller (current): Ali Albaharna, operating the service Whisco TV at <https://whisco.tv>, Kingdom of Bahrain. Intended controller on incorporation: Whisco Media W.L.L., trading as Whisco TV. Contact for privacy requests: privacy@whisco.tv (aliases to legal@whisco.tv until a separate mailbox is created). Supervisory authority: Personal Data Protection Authority, Kingdom of Bahrain — <https://www.pdp.gov.bh/>

4.2 The short version

- You can watch without creating an account.
- The iOS and Android apps, in the versions shipping at the date of this policy, collect no personal data. Store nutrition labels read “Data Not Collected.” There is no analytics SDK, no advertising SDK, and no crash-reporter SDK in those binaries.
- The website uses Vercel Web Analytics, which Vercel describes as cookieless and privacy-friendly. It tells us aggregate page views. It is not used to build a profile of you.
- If you optionally create an account, we store the email address and the watchlist / resume position you choose to sync.
- We do not sell personal data. We do not run a subscription, so we do not store card numbers.

4.3 Personal data we process, by surface

A. Website, no account (default)

Data	Why	Basis (template)	Kept
Technical logs reasonably necessary to operate the site (IP, user-agent, timestamp)	Security, abuse, debugging	Legitimate interests / service requested	30 days unless needed for an incident
Vercel Web Analytics events (page path, referrer, coarse country, anonymised)	Understand which pages work	Legitimate interests; no cookies	Per Vercel retention
Strictly necessary local storage (playback / language)	Make the site work	Necessary for the service requested	Until cleared by the user

We do not set advertising cookies on the website in the current configuration. If AdSense approval introduces a cookie or advertising identifier, this table will be updated before that tag ships, and a consent mechanism will be added if counsel advises that consent is the correct PDPL basis.

B. Website, optional account

Data	Why	Basis	Kept
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Email address, password hash (never plaintext)	Account	Contract / steps at the user's request	Life of the account + 30 days
Synced watchlist and resume position	Feature you turned on	Contract	Life of the account
Support emails you send us	Answer you	Contract / legitimate interests	24 months

C. Official iOS and Android apps (current binaries)

No personal data is collected. Watchlist and resume live on-device. We do not receive them. If a future version (v1.1 or later) adds analytics, crash reporting, or ads, we will: (1) change store privacy labels first, (2) update this Policy, (3) ship the binary only after both stores reflect the new labels.

D. Rights-holder, partner, and applicant data

Name, role, email, phone, company, and contract files of people who write to legal@whisco.tv or who negotiate a licence. Basis: contract and legitimate interests. Kept for the life of the contract plus the limitation period under Bahrain law (counsel to specify).

E. Data we do not collect

Precise GPS; contacts; photos; microphone; government ID; payment cards; religion, health, or other sensitive personal data as defined in the PDPL; children's accounts.

4.4 Processors and international transfers

Processor	Role	Typical location
Vercel	Application hosting, Web Analytics	United States and Vercel's edge network
Neon	Postgres database	Processor's nominated region (record the live region here)
Google	AdSense when approved; YouTube embed is a third-party player	United States and Google's network
Apple / Google	App distribution	United States and local storefronts
Planned CDN (e.g. Bunny)	Licensed-file delivery	Record live PoPs

The PDPL restricts transfers of personal data outside Bahrain except to a jurisdiction designated as adequate, or with PDPA authorisation, or under a listed exception (including the data subject's consent). This is an open counsel item. Until it is closed: minimise what leaves Bahrain, keep account data only as needed, and do not add new US SDKs.

YouTube embeds are served by Google under YouTube's terms. Playback on an embed is a request the user's browser or the official player makes to Google. We do not receive the video file.

4.5 Your rights (PDPL Arts. 17–24 and Resolution 48)

Subject to the limits in the PDPL, you may: be informed (this Policy); access; rectify; block or erase data processed unlawfully, that is inaccurate, or whose processing causes unwarranted substantial damage; object to processing, including to direct marketing aimed at you; withdraw consent where consent was the basis; and complain to the PDPA.

How: email privacy@whisco.tv from the address we hold (or with enough detail to identify you). We will verify identity before releasing data. Target response: 15 business days, faster if the request is simple. We do not do automated decision-making that produces legal effects about you. Catalogue ranking is not a decision about a person.

4.6 Children, marketing, security, breaches, changes

The service is not directed at children. We do not knowingly collect personal data from anyone under 13, or under the higher age required by a destination country's child-digital-safety law. If a parent or guardian believes we have done so, write to privacy@whisco.tv and we will delete it. Do not create an account for a child.

We do not currently send marketing email. If we ever do, it will be opt-in, with an unsubscribe in every message, and we will honour PDPL objection rights. Community posts on third-party forums are written by a human and are not direct marketing to a particular person using a personal-data profile.

Security is described for staff in Policy 6. In public terms: HTTPS; passwords hashed; secrets not in git; access limited to the founder and systems acting under the founder's direction; catalogue backups without user-password material.

If a personal-data breach is likely to affect data-subject rights, we notify the PDPA within 72 hours of discovery (Order No. 43 of 2022) and we notify affected individuals when the PDPL requires it.

Material changes will be posted on this page with a new effective date. If we start collecting app data, the store labels and this Policy change first.

5. Terms of Service v2

Document ID WT-TOS-005

Classification Public

REQUIRES QUALIFIED LEGAL REVIEW

Consumer-facing terms. Counsel should commission a controlling Arabic text if these are to be relied on in Bahrain filings, and should confirm the liability cap against mandatory consumer rules.

5.1 The service and the operator

Whisco TV is a free, advertising-supported audiovisual service. It organises legally sourced live channels and on-demand titles for expatriate and other audiences. It is not a subscription. It is not a pirate IPTV reseller. It is not a licensed linear broadcaster. By using <https://whisco.tv> or an official app, you agree to these Terms and to the Privacy Policy.

Current operator: Ali Albaharna, Kingdom of Bahrain, trading as Whisco TV. On incorporation: Whisco Media W.L.L., trading as Whisco TV. Contact: legal@whisco.tv.

5.2 Free access; territorial availability

You may browse and watch without an account. An account, if offered, is optional and exists only to sync a watchlist. We will never require a paid subscription to use the service. “Free forever” is a product promise of the operator; it is not a perpetual covenant that binds a future purchaser of the company. If ownership ever changes, users will be told.

The catalogue is curated for the six GCC states (Bahrain, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, Kuwait, Qatar, Oman). Individual titles are shown only where our verification indicates they are available. Availability outside the GCC is incidental and unsupported. We do not provide VPNs, DNS hacks, or geo-unblocking. We may block or limit the service in a territory where offering it would be unlawful.

5.3 Licence you receive

You receive a revocable, non-exclusive, non-transferable permission to stream the service for personal, non-commercial viewing on a device you control. You do not receive a copy of any file; the right to download (except any official in-app offline feature we may later ship under licence); the right to rebroadcast, re-embed, frame, scrape for a competing catalogue, or include our streams in an m3u; or any rights in the Whisco name, the Whisco dog, or the UI. Third-party players (including official YouTube embeds) are governed by those publishers' terms as well as these Terms.

5.4 Acceptable use

You will not: use the service to infringe copyright or neighbouring rights; attempt to bypass geo gates, player restrictions, or ad placement; scrape, bulk-harvest, or republish the catalogue or stream endpoints; introduce malware or overload the service; impersonate Whisco, including by selling “Whisco premium” or a fake installer; upload content (this is not a user-generated-video platform); or use the service if you are not old enough to contract in your place of residence, or if you are a child using an account. We may hide titles, suspend an account, or block an IP range if this section is broken.

5.5 Accounts, advertising, intellectual property

If you create an account you must give an email address you control and keep the password to yourself. We may close an account that is used for abuse, that was created for a child, or that has been inactive for 24 months. You may close your account by writing to privacy@whisco.tv.

The service is ad-supported. Advertising is governed by Policy 3. You agree that display advertising (and, on licensed own-player titles, video advertising) will be shown. You do not agree to pop-unders or to ads over the player — those are forbidden by our own policy. If you see one, tell us.

The compilation of the catalogue, the software, the marks, and the original editorial guides are owned by the operator or its licensors. Individual films, series and broadcasts remain the property of their rights holders. Notices go to legal@whisco.tv under Policy 2.

5.6 No warranties

THE SERVICE IS PROVIDED “AS IS” AND “AS AVAILABLE.” STREAMS FAIL. CHANNELS GO DARK. A TITLE THAT PLAYED YESTERDAY MAY BE HIDDEN TODAY BECAUSE A GEO CHECK FAILED OR A RIGHTS HOLDER WROTE TO US. TO THE MAXIMUM EXTENT PERMITTED BY BAHRAIN LAW, WE DISCLAIM ALL WARRANTIES, INCLUDING MERCHANTABILITY, FITNESS FOR A PARTICULAR PURPOSE, AND NON-INFRINGEMENT.

We do not warrant that live sport, day-one theatrical films, or any particular premium channel will be available. We say so on the site because it is true.

5.7 Limitation of liability; indemnity

TO THE MAXIMUM EXTENT PERMITTED BY BAHRAIN LAW, THE OPERATOR IS NOT LIABLE FOR INDIRECT, INCIDENTAL, SPECIAL, CONSEQUENTIAL, OR PUNITIVE DAMAGES, OR FOR LOST PROFITS, LOST DATA, OR THE COST OF SUBSTITUTE SERVICES, ARISING OUT OF THE SERVICE OR THESE TERMS, EVEN IF ADVISED OF THE POSSIBILITY.

OUR TOTAL LIABILITY FOR ANY CLAIM ARISING OUT OF THE SERVICE OR THESE TERMS IS LIMITED TO TWO HUNDRED UNITED STATES DOLLARS (USD 200) OR THE EQUIVALENT IN BAHRAINI DINARS. Some things cannot be limited under applicable law (for example liability for fraud or for personal injury caused by negligence). Those things are not limited.

If you break these Terms or scrape / republish the service commercially, you will indemnify the operator against claims, damages, and reasonable legal fees that result.

5.8 Changes, law, language

We may change these Terms by posting a new version. Continued use after the posting is acceptance. We may stop the service, or a part of it, at any time. You may stop using the service at any time.

These Terms are governed by the laws of the Kingdom of Bahrain. The competent courts of the Kingdom of Bahrain have exclusive jurisdiction, without prejudice to any mandatory consumer-forum right that a statute gives you in your place of residence.

We may publish these Terms in English and in other languages. If there is a conflict, the English text controls until counsel commissions a controlling Arabic text for Bahrain filings.

6. Data Protection & Security Policy (internal)

Document ID WT-SEC-006

Classification Internal — do not publish

REQUIRES QUALIFIED LEGAL REVIEW · INTERNAL ONLY

Implements PDPL duties in a company that is two people and an automated platform. Controls must be executable without a security department.

6.1 Roles

Role	Person	Duty
Data controller / authorised manager	Ali Albaharna (then the W.L.L.)	Decides purposes and means; signs processor terms; notifies PDPA
Data Protection Officer	Counsel to advise whether appointment is mandatory or useful	If appointed: register with PDPA; keep the processing record
Engineering agent	Acts only under founder direction	Implements technical measures; does not take production secrets off approved systems
Processors	Vercel, Neon, Google, Apple, future CDN	Written terms required

6.2 Processing inventory

Maintain a single inventory listing: processing activity, data categories, data subjects, purpose, basis, processor, location, retention, deletion method. Update it when a new SDK, a new form, or a new vendor is added. Current activities: website delivery and security logs; Vercel Web Analytics (aggregate); optional user accounts and synced watchlists; support and legal mailboxes; partner / licensor files; app distribution (no personal data received from the current binaries).

Default product path collects nothing identifiable beyond what the host logs for security. Account data exists only because the user asked for sync. No sensitive personal data (PDPL definition) is processed. No sale of personal data. No broker lists.

6.3 Secrets and access control

1. Production secrets (database URLs, API tokens, Apple/Google keys, AdSense codes) live in the host's secret store (Vercel environment variables or successor). They are never committed to git, never pasted into a ticket, never sent in WhatsApp.
2. Local .env files are gitignored. If a secret is exposed, it is rotated the same day.
3. Production database access is limited to the founder and to automated jobs using scoped credentials.
4. The engineering agent does not receive a standing copy of production secrets in chat. Secrets are injected by the platform.
5. App-store and domain-registrar accounts use unique passwords and the platform's MFA.
6. Legal mailbox access is limited to the founder. When a contractor is ever hired, access is named, time-boxed, and revoked on the last day.

6.4 Technical measures and processor contracts

- TLS on all public endpoints.
- Password hashing with a modern adaptive algorithm (record the live algorithm in the inventory).
- Principle of least privilege on the database role the web app uses.

- Catalogue snapshots in git contain editorial metadata, not user password hashes or email lists. User tables are backed up inside the database vendor's encrypted backup, not into a public repo.
- Dependency updates on the weekly maintenance cadence. Uptime checks every 15 minutes probe availability, not user records.

Before a new processor sees personal data: a written agreement that requires the processor to act only on instructions, keep security, notify us of a breach, and not appoint sub-processors that break this policy. Vercel / Neon / Google online terms are the current documents; counsel should confirm they satisfy PDPL processor duties.

6.5 Breach response (Order No. 43 of 2022)

A personal-data breach is accidental or unlawful destruction, loss, alteration, unauthorised disclosure of, or access to, personal data we process.

1. Contain (hour 0–4). Rotate the exposed secret. Take the affected endpoint down if that stops the leak. Preserve logs.
2. Record. Date/time of discovery, what happened, what data, how many people (if knowable), likely consequences, measures taken. This record is mandatory even if we do not notify.
3. Assess risk to data subjects. Security logs of IPs, with no account data, will often be “unlikely to affect rights.” An exported table of emails and password hashes is the opposite.
4. Notify the PDPA within 72 hours of discovery unless the breach would not affect data-subject rights. If we miss 72 hours, the notice includes the reason for delay.
5. Notify data subjects when required (high risk, and none of the encryption / subsequent-measures / disproportionate-effort exceptions apply). Use clear language. Offer a practical step (reset password).
6. Close. Root cause, what changes, date closed.

Notification contents (minimum): type of breach; categories and approximate number of data subjects and records; likely consequences; measures taken or proposed; name and contact of the controller / DPO. Do not notify “just in case” in a public blog post that creates the harm. Notify the Authority first.

6.6 DSARs, retention, training

privacy@whisco.tv is monitored by the founder. Verify identity. Search account table, support mailbox, and partner files. Respond in 15 business days. Log the request. A mailbox folder named DSAR-YYYY is enough; no ticketing product is required.

Record	Retention
Server / security logs	30 days
Analytics aggregates	Vendor default
Account profile	Life of account + 30 days
Support mail	24 months
Takedown log and legal notices	5 years or the limitation period, whichever longer
Licence contracts	Life of contract + limitation period
Breach file	5 years

Deletion means removal from the live database and expiry from the vendor backup cycle. Git history of the catalogue is not a user-data store and is not purged to honour a user erasure request. The “staff” is the founder. This document is the training. Re-read it when adding a vendor or an SDK.

7. Editorial Independence & Curation Guidelines

Document ID WT-EDT-007

Classification Internal + public summary

REQUIRES QUALIFIED LEGAL REVIEW

Curation rules for a catalogue product. Not a newsroom code.

7.1 What “editorial” means here

Whisco is not a newsroom and not a studio. Curation means: which legally sourced titles are featured on a home-row, which language shelf is emphasised, which of the seven hand-written guides is linked, and how a title is described. Those choices affect what an expat household sees first. They must not be for sale in the dark.

7.2 How featured content is chosen

A title or channel may be featured because of one or more of the following disclosed criteria:

1. Catalogue health — the official endpoint is up; geo checks pass for the user’s GCC state.
2. Language and community fit — Malayalam, Hindi, Urdu, Tagalog, Arabic, Turkish, and the other shelves exist because those are the households we serve, not because a studio paid.
3. Freshness — a new official episode of a series we already carry (Turkish dizi daily updater; other official feeds).
4. Completeness — a series of which we hold a lawful complete run is more useful than a fragment.
5. Seasonal relevance — Eid, Diwali, Ramadan, school holidays, cricket season (never pirated live rights).
6. User helpfulness of an editorial guide — the seven long-form guides exist to help a human choose, not to manufacture keywords. They stay hand-written.

Automated ranking may use the above signals. It may not use a paid-placement flag unless that flag also turns on a public “Sponsored” label.

7.3 What may not buy a feature

- A licensor’s revenue-share rate.
- A threat to withhold a catalogue.
- A personal relationship.
- An AdSense advertiser’s demand to sit next to a particular title (that is also an Advertising Standards violation if it puts an ad on the player).

7.4 Paid placement

If we ever sell a home-row or a “spotlight” to a brand or a licensor: the unit is labelled Sponsored / إعلان in the UI; the commercial terms sit in a written insertion order; editorial guides are not rewritten to match the sponsor; we may refuse a sponsor that contradicts Policy 1 or Policy 3. Until the first such sale exists, the public summary is: we do not sell featured placement.

7.5 Honesty doctrine

- Do not invent traffic numbers. The audience is early-stage.
- Do not claim live premium sport or day-one theatrical windows we do not have.
- Do not describe YouTube embeds as “Whisco originals.”

- Do not describe a hidden geo-blocked title as “coming soon” if the real reason is a failed GCC check.
- Community posts are written and published by a human. Automation may draft; it may not post.

We carry official news and religious FTA channels that pass Policy 1. We do not run a political desk. We do not endorse a party or a candidate. Featured placement is not used to amplify a political message.

If a guide states a fact that is wrong (a series count, a platform claim), correct it in the guide. Do not silently delete the page to hide the mistake.

8. Partner Code of Conduct

Document ID WT-PCC-008

Classification Shared with counterparties (schedule to a licence)

REQUIRES QUALIFIED LEGAL REVIEW

Attach as a schedule to a Filmhub-class or direct licence. Does not replace the licence.

8.1 Who this applies to

Any person who delivers films, series, artwork, audio, subtitles, or metadata that Whisco will play in its own player or hold out as licensed. Official YouTube embeds that we merely frame under Policy 1 are not “partners” for this Code; the originating publisher’s terms govern those.

8.2 Warranties we need

The partner warrants that:

1. It holds, or is authorised to grant, the AVOD / FAST rights for the contracted territories (at minimum the six GCC states, or a listed subset) for the term.
2. Files, artwork, and subtitles do not infringe a third party’s copyright, trade mark, or personality right.
3. Files are the licensed masters or approved proxies, not a pirate encode, cam, or leaked screener.
4. Files do not contain malware, unexpected executable payloads, or tracking that would change our app-store privacy labels without notice.
5. The partner is not a designated person on the sanctions lists in Policy 1.6, and the titles are not the official programming of such a person.
6. Age rating and content descriptors supplied with the metadata are accurate enough for a family living-room service to place the title.

8.3 Delivery and operations

- Delivery to the contracted ingest (S3-compatible or successor), in the codec / package the technical schedule names.
- Territory and window metadata accurate on day one and updated when a window expires.
- The partner names a single email for takedown and quality issues. We name legal@whisco.tv.
- If a third party serves the partner with a credible infringement claim on a title we carry under the licence, the partner tells us within two business days and we hide first.

8.4 Commercial posture (current stage)

- Revenue-share only. No minimum guarantee. No upfront licence fee. No exclusivity, unless both parties later sign an amendment.
- Reporting monthly, from playback logs, in the format the licence names.
- Either party may decline to renew a title without inventing a quality pretext.

8.5 Conduct we will not accept

- Pressure to carry a title that fails Policy 1 (including a title that is not GCC-clearable).
- Pressure to place an advertisement on or over the player, or to add a second ad slot, in breach of Policy 3.
- Pressure to mark a paid title as organically featured in breach of Policy 7.
- Delivery of sexually explicit, CSAM, or sanctions-listed material.

- Public statements that Whisco “stole” a title while a notice is in the Policy 2 process.
- Incentivising fake traffic to inflate rev-share. We do not buy traffic. We will not pay a share that is visibly the product of fraud, and we will say so in the report.

8.6 Our corresponding commitments

Whisco commits to partners that we will: keep the anti-piracy doctrine (it protects their catalogue as much as ours); honour Policy 2 SLAs on their titles; not geo-unblock a title into a territory the licence excludes; not insert a subscription paywall in front of their title; not ship an ad format that the Advertising Standards Policy forbids; and report honestly, including when the number is small.

8.7 Breach and contact

Material breach of §§8.2–8.5 is grounds to hide the affected titles immediately and to terminate the licence under its termination clause. CSAM or sanctions breaches are immediate and company-wide.

legal@whisco.tv · <https://whisco.tv>

Annex A — Publication checklist

Before any public policy goes live on whisco.tv:

- Counsel has marked up this suite once.
- Registered address and telephone of the designated representative are filled in.
- Operator name matches the live CR (or the founder, if still pre-CR).
- privacy@whisco.tv and legal@whisco.tv both deliver to a mailbox the founder reads.
- </legal/takedown> page publishes Article 52 particulars.
- App-store privacy labels still match Policy 4 §4.3.C.
- AdSense tag, if live, matches Policy 3 and the cookie table in Policy 4.
- Arabic summary of Terms + Privacy commissioned if counsel so advises.

Annex B — Open counsel items

1. PDPA notification / prior authorisation (PDPL Arts. 14–15; Resolution 44) and DPO appointment.
2. Legal basis for transfers to Vercel / Google / Apple in the United States.
3. Whether catalogue aggregation of official FTA / embeds is an activity that needs an IAA / media or TRA authorisation in Bahrain.
4. Whether to file a US Copyright Office DMCA designated-agent registration in addition to the Article 52 representative.
5. Controlling language (English vs Arabic) for consumer-facing terms.
6. Confirm 10–14 day counter-notice restore window against Articles 55–57 as currently in force.
7. Child-directed age threshold across BH / SA / AE / KW / QA / OM storefronts.
8. Insert postal address and telephone before Article 52 publication.

End of suite. Templates only. Requires qualified legal review. Version 2.0 — 5 September 2026.